

CONVICTION

8

No. of accused sentenced to two years in jail but granted bail soon. CBI chargesheet named 12 entities (9 individuals and 3 corporates)

PENDING CLAIM CASES

952

With Additional Welfare Commissioner

522

In Welfare Commissioner Revisional Court

18

In high court and Supreme Court



11,278

No. of cancer patients who received ex-gratia

1,855

No. of people with fatal kidney diseases who got ex-gratia

$470 MN

Paid by Union Carbide Corporation in 1989

MEDICAL INFRASTRUCTURE

7*

No. of hospitals

1,014

No. of beds

98

No. of dispensaries

**Includes 350-bed Bhopal Memorial Hospital and Research Centre*

pitals. Free treatment for ailments such as carcinoma and kidney disease, once guaranteed, is now tied to the Ayushman Bharat scheme, complicating access for survivors. The BMHRC, once staffed by some of the country's best doctors, has seen an exodus of specialists to private hospitals, leaving its future uncertain.

Environmental hazards from the tragedy continue to plague the city of lakes. Recently, the state government, with a central assistance of Rs 126 crore, decided to incinerate 336 tonnes of toxic waste lying at the Union Carbide plant site. Activists argue that the measure is insufficient—it covers only a paltry 0.028 per cent of the 1.2 million tonnes of hazardous material. This was estimated in a 2010 study by the National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (NEERI), which was rejected by the state government. "The disposal is not going to help the people of Bhopal as it is just a fraction of the entire toxic material lying at the site. We demand a comprehensive scientific survey to determine the depth and spread of the waste so that the extent of toxicity is known," says Rachna Dhingra of the Bhopal Group for Information and Action, an organisation working for the gas tragedy victims.

The contamination has already had serious consequences. Activists cite 17 studies by government and independent bodies, including NEERI, stressing that soil and groundwater have been contaminated, particularly due to breached linings in the plant's solar evaporation pond and 29 unlined pits. Efforts to incinerate the waste between 2013 and 2015 failed six times, leaving residents newly exposed to environmental risks.

Broken promises of rehabilitation have exacerbated survivors' struggles. Activists highlight discrepancies in the government's claims of jobs provided for gas victims versus those verified by independent agencies. Many survivors feel abandoned, with inadequate steps taken to address their long-term health and economic challenges as one of the deadliest industrial disasters on the planet continues to cast a haunting shadow. ■